

Materials Provided by the Students

Overview

Here we organize the student-provided materials by the time that you will have access to them.

Online Materials

The following materials are all required and will be available through the *ProjectBoard* site for your inspection as each student's materials are approved by the Fair. Some of these materials may not be available until only about 10 days prior to judging.

- Abstract
- Quad Chart
- Project Presentation
- Public Video
- ISEF forms

In-Person Materials

The following materials will be located in the student's assigned booth within the Exhibit Hall.

- Abstract
- Poster
- ISEF Forms
- Research notebook (optional)
- Research paper (optional)
- Video Demonstration (optional)

Descriptions

Abstract

This is an unstructured paragraph or two describing the project in no more than 250 words. The rules of the fair require that this work summarize "the current year's work" and "must describe research conducted by the student, not by the supervising adult(s)." It is provided to judges both before the fair online and during the fair next to the project display.

When at the fair the abstract will appear on an official form, the Official Abstract and Certification. The original of this form will be embossed with a gold seal when the project display is certified by the fair for presentation to the judges and the public. Typically, it is hung from the front edge of the display table. Judges should never take the original with the embossed gold seal, but photocopies of this form will be available at the project display.

Quad Chart

The Quad Chart is a structured summary of the project on a single page following a strict layout specified by the Fair whose body content is divided into the following four equal-sized quadrants:

1. Research Question/ Problem/ Engineering Objectives
2. Methodology/ Framework/ Project Design
3. Data Analysis & Results/ Findings
4. Interpretation & Conclusions.

Three different templates are provided to the students with quadrant titles dependent upon the nature of the project. The Quad Chart is available online only and is meant to be a visual high-level summary of the project for a judge to absorb with a quick review prior to delving into the project details provided within the *Project Presentation*.

Project Presentation

This PDF document is the online version of the project display. In advance of the fair, judges will rely on this document as the most complete description of the project. Students are given detailed instructions on the structure of this document in order to address all of the issues of concern to judges. This document is then checked for conformance with those instructions before it is exposed to the judges. Among these directions are the requirement that the total number of pages cannot exceed 12 and each page must be easily readable when viewing the entire page at once. These requirements are intended for your benefit so as to encourage the students to focus on the important and relevant aspects of their projects in the limited space within this document.

Public Video

This is a two-minute video intended primarily for the general public who will visit the Fair during Public Day (the day after interviews), but it is also available to judges who wish to get a more complete sense of the student(s) behind the project.

Poster

This is the conventional vision of a science fair project display. Many posters will have the traditional tri-fold structure; many others will be a single plane. Most posters will stand on a table within the project's booth, but others will be free-standing on the ground. Regardless of formatting details, in all cases posters will be confined to a space 4 feet wide, 2-1/2 feet deep, and extending no higher than 9 feet from the floor.

These posters are available for your inspection on Tuesday, your registration day, while on Wednesday, the students will wait in front of their posters for you to interview them so that you can both refer to the text and images on the poster to better inform the interview.

Optional In-Person Items

You may find the following items at some project displays, but they are not required of anyone.

Research Notebook

The original notebook in which the student recorded the progress of their work.

Research Paper

Some students will have prepared a research paper summarizing their work. This paper may even be prepared in anticipation of publication.

Demonstration Video

This video is distinct from the Public Video listed above in that it is meant solely to demonstrate some aspect of the project that is difficult or impossible to show within the Exhibit Hall.

ISEF Forms Required to Be Displayed with the Poster

The following two forms are required to be visible at the display, but only for projects where they are relevant. You should review these forms if you have any questions on their issues.

Form 1C: Regulated Research Institutional/Industrial Setting Form

This is required of any project conducted in a regulated research institution, industrial setting, or any work site other than home, school, or field at any time during the current ISEF project year. This form is completed by the research institution in order to explain to the Fair, and to you, how the research institution supported the student's work. That is, you should learn here what the research institutions did for the students and what the students did for themselves.

Form 7: Continuation/Research Progression Projects Form

This is required of any project based on the student's prior research. Such projects must document that the current year's research is a substantive expansion from prior work. Only research performed in a 12-month period beginning in January of the previous year can be displayed on the Poster. Form 7 provides an tabular view for easy comparison of the current year's work with that in prior years.

ISEF Forms Required to Be Present, But Not Displayed

You should never need to view the following forms because they do not bear on the scientific/engineering content of the project. They are of importance to the Fair through its Display and Safety (D&S) Committee ensuring compliance with the fair's rules. Typically, these forms are contained in a student notebook for easy access when requested by the D&S Committee.

- Form 1: Checklist for Adult Sponsor
- Form 1A: Student Checklist/ Research Plan
- Form 1B: Approval Form
- Sample Photographic/Video Release Form
- Form 2: Qualified Scientist Form
- Form 3: Risk Assessment Form
- Form 4: Human Participants Form
- Sample Informed Consent Form
- Forms 5A/5B: Vertebrate Animal Forms
- Form 6A: Potentially Hazardous Biological Agents Form
- Form 6B: Human and Vertebrate Animal Tissue Form

One final note: In those cases where students were required to have signed Informed Consent Forms, only a sample should be present. No actual signed Informed Consent Forms should have entered the Exhibit Hall. Again, you don't need to worry about this because the ISEF D&S Committee will have checked for this before the project was approved for competition.